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AWS MARKETPLACE GTM

SESSION 3 · GET BOUGHT

A pricing story that survives procurement.

Price to the unit of value the buyer actually gets — then tell the story that makes it defensible when the deal hits a procurement review.

Most teams price to their cost.

They add up what it costs to build and run, sprinkle margin on top, and ship a number. The buyer doesn't care what it cost you — they care what it's worth to them.

// COST-PLUS PRICING

What it costs you

Compute + headcount + margin. Internally logical, externally meaningless. Caps your price at your costs, not the buyer's upside.

// VALUE PRICING

What it's worth to them

Priced to the outcome the buyer captures. The number rises with their success, and the story writes itself.

// THE REFRAME

Your price is a claim about the buyer's outcome — make it one they'd defend internally.

When the champion has to justify the spend to finance, your pricing story is the argument they reuse.

Find the thing that scales with their success.

The value metric is the unit you charge by — and the right one goes up only when the buyer is winning. Pick wrong and you punish your best customers or leave money on weak ones.

1. **It tracks the outcome,** not your effort — seats used, GB processed, deals closed, spend optimized.
2. **It's legible before purchase** — the buyer can estimate their bill without a sales call.
3. **It grows with value, not friction** — paying more should feel like getting more, never like a penalty.

candidate: **per seat**

candidate: **per GB / API call**

candidate: **% of spend saved**

candidate: **per outcome closed**

Does your price track that metric today?

We map your current pricing against the value metric we just named and find the mismatch — where you over- or under-charge relative to the value delivered.

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER
What's our current pricing unit?	
What's the real value metric?	
Where do they diverge?	
Who's mispriced because of it?	

Three tiers, one obvious next rung.

TIER 1

Entry

For the buyer proving it works

- → Low-friction start, self-serve
- → The core outcome, capped scope
- → No procurement gauntlet to begin

MOST BUYERS LAND HERE

TIER 2

Standard

For the team adopting it for real

- → Full product at the value metric
- → Support & SLA procurement needs
- → The price your story is built around

TIER 3

Committed

For the org standardizing on you

- → Volume / committed-spend pricing
- → Private offer, EDP/MACC-eligible
- → Where the biggest deals unlock

Why it's priced this way — in the buyer's words.

The narrative is the sentence your champion repeats to their finance team. We write it so the price feels inevitable, not negotiable.

// THE NARRATIVE TEMPLATE

"You pay by ______ because that's the value you capture. At your scale, that's $____ — against $____ of upside."

When the unit and the upside are stated in the same breath, procurement stops asking "why so much?" and starts asking "how soon?"

// ANCHOR

To value, not cost

Anchor the price against the upside or the cost of the status quo — never against your build cost.

// JUSTIFY

The unit makes sense

Explain why the value metric is the fair unit. A logical unit defends itself.

// EQUIP

Arm the champion

Give them the one-liner that wins the internal argument when you're not in the room.

Price so an agent can buy too.

Increasingly the thing evaluating your pricing is software. It can't sit through a sales call. If your base path isn't expressible as data, the agent skips you.

// UNITS

Clear units

A defined, named unit an agent can read and reason about — not a bespoke quote.

// COST

Predictable cost

The buyer (or its agent) can compute the bill from inputs, before committing.

// TERMS

Machine-readable terms

A standard-contract or metered path an agent can accept without a human handshake.

// THE RULE

If your base price says "contact us," an agent reads it as "unavailable."

Keep one fully self-serve, fully legible path — even if the big deals still go through you.

Private offers & committed spend.

The list price gets the deal started; private offers and committed-spend motions are where the large numbers actually close. Knowing when to move a buyer to tier 3 is the skill.

MOTION	WHAT IT IS	WHEN TO REACH FOR IT
Private offer	A custom price/term for a specific buyer	When the deal is bigger than your list tiers fit.
Committed spend	Multi-period commitment at a better rate	When the buyer is standardizing and wants predictability.
EDP / MACC fit	Counts toward their AWS commitment	When the buyer has an AWS spend commitment to burn down — your offer becomes nearly free to them.

The procurement-defensibility test.

Before we call it done, your pricing has to pass the questions a procurement reviewer will ask. We run them now, on your numbers.

1. **Can the buyer predict their bill** from public info, without a call?
2. **Is the unit defensible?** Could the champion explain why you charge this way in one sentence?
3. **Does the price map to a budget** line the buyer already has — or to AWS committed spend?
4. **Is there a no-handshake path** to start, so evaluation doesn't wait on a contract?

Put the ladder on your pricing page.

The story only works where buyers see it. This week the three-tier table and the narrative go onto your real pricing page and into your sales deck.

- [ ] Build the 3-tier package table into your pricing page. — entry / standard / committed, live.
- [ ] Add the pricing narrative — the why, in the buyer's words. — arm the champion.
- [ ] Confirm one self-serve, agent-readable path exists. — no "contact us" on the base tier.
- [ ] Send me the page for an async markup before session 4. — I pressure-test the defensibility.